

ATB — Attachment Theory and the Biblical Triad

An Integration for Christian Formation: Trust, Love, and Hope through the Lens of Attachment Theory

Working draft v1 · synthesizing three John-Tittle source papers (Warrior Monk × Attachment-Informed Christian / TPM packet; AnswerThis.io "Trust and Attachment"; GPT-5 "Trust, Love, Hope and Attachment Theory v6") into a candidate eighth Formation Document for IJH.

Preface — How This Paper Came To Be

[FLAG for John: this is your "why I wrote this" preface — the personal entry point. Sources you might pull from: the GPT-5 paper's opening paragraph about the Sower question; your decades of FotH practice; the moment in your own journey when attachment theory clicked for you. Two short paragraphs is enough. The rest of the paper is more formal; this is the kitchen-table opening.]

The starting question is the Sower's question — why does the same Word land in some hearts as hardened path, in others as rocky ground, in others as thorny soil, and in others as good soil that produces fruit thirtyfold, sixtyfold, and a hundredfold? The Affective Taxonomy gives one answer: the variance is developmental, mapping the four soils to internalization levels (V2.Exp1; HFT; MSF). The Foundational Laws give another: the variance is structural, mapping the soils to the operation of specific laws — Sowing-and-Reaping, Confession-and-Restoration, the Obedience Channel, the Hardening Law (V1).

This paper proposes a third complementary answer, one that does not replace the first two but enriches them: the variance is also relational. The capacity of a heart to receive, to keep, and to bring to fruit the Word God plants in it is shaped — though not determined — by the relational history through which the person learned (or failed to learn) that closeness with a trustworthy other is safe. Attachment theory, the body of research initiated by Bowlby and Ainsworth and extended by Hazan, Shaver, Mikulincer, Granqvist, and Kirkpatrick, names that relational history with precision. The Reformed/evangelical/charismatic theological tradition in which this paper is written names the gospel that re-grounds it.

1. What This Paper Adds to the Formation Documents

The seven existing Formation Documents form a coherent set:

- TA — Theological Anthropology supplies the doctrine of the person (Spirit, Heart, Soul, Mind, Body) on which the other six are built.

- HFT — Heart Formation Theology identifies the Affective Taxonomy as the developmental framework and trust in scripture as the tractable target.
- SST — Soul and Spirit Taxonomies extends the developmental framework into the soul and spirit dimensions parallel to HFT's treatment of heart.
- MSFIG — Model of Spiritual Formation for Individuals and Small Groups integrates the three inner taxonomies and extends them to individual, small-group, and church-wide application.
- MSF — Measuring Spiritual Formation at Scale scales the framework across five organizational levels (individual, group, congregation, denomination, universal church) and supplies the measurement-instrument analysis.
- FC — Formation Companion proposes the synthesis role of the formation facilitator with a three-level developmental progression.
- 4Cs — Four Connects names the four primary connection points (Self, Others, God, Mission/World) the formation work cultivates.

Each of these papers presupposes that the believer can receive what is being formed. What they have not formally named is the relational substrate that determines how receivable formation is in the first place. A person with a secure attachment history walks into the formation work with the affective scaffolding for trust, vulnerability, lament, and response already partially in place. A person with an insecure history — anxious, avoidant, or disorganized — walks in with that scaffolding partially missing or actively distorted, and the formation work must address the substrate as well as the building.

ATB names that substrate, describes the four standard attachment patterns and their characteristic distortions, and proposes specific operational practices (drawn from John's Fellowship of the Heart work and the TPM Whole-Person packet) by which the Holy Spirit, through reliable relational community and scriptural meditation, progressively repatterns the substrate toward what the New Testament calls the triad of faith, hope, and love (1 Cor 13:13; 1 Thess 1:3; Col 1:4–5; Gal 5:6).

The paper has three structural moves:

1. Diagnostic — naming the four attachment patterns as relational profiles that color how a person receives the Word, prays, relates in community, and engages the formation work
2. Theological — locating the gospel as the source of "earned security" (the attachment-theory term for the corrective experience by which insecure patterns become secure ones) and naming the church as the relational ecology God ordinarily uses to do that work
3. Operational — proposing the FotH practices (TPM, attachment-style practice cards, whole-person integration matrix) as the concrete formation work that operationalizes the theological claim

The novel structural contribution to the IJH framework: attachment-style profiles as a parallel mapping to the Sower soils, complementary to the Affective-Taxonomy mapping already developed in V2.Exp1: The Heart Soil — A Diagnostic Map. The paper proposes that a person

whose Sower-diagnostic shows hard-path or rocky soil in a given region of life may show a corresponding attachment-pattern signature in that same region — and that the operational work of clearing the soil includes the relational work of addressing the substrate.

2. Attachment Theory: A Brief Orientation

Attachment theory was developed by John Bowlby (1907–1990), an English psychiatrist and psychoanalyst, in response to clinical observations of children separated from caregivers during and after World War II. Bowlby proposed that human infants possess an innate behavioral system whose function is to maintain proximity to a primary caregiver under conditions of threat or distress, and that the quality of that early caregiving experience produces durable "internal working models" of self, others, and the relationship between them. Mary Ainsworth's empirical work in the 1960s–1970s identified the now-classic four attachment patterns in infant–caregiver dyads:

- Secure attachment develops when the caregiver responds sensitively, predictably, and warmly to the child's signals. The child learns that distress is met with comfort and exploration is welcomed back to a reliable base. Internal working model: I matter; others can be trusted; the world is explorable.
- Anxious attachment (also called anxious-ambivalent or preoccupied) develops when the caregiver's response is inconsistent — sometimes warm, sometimes intrusive, sometimes absent — without a pattern the child can predict. The child learns to hyperactivate the attachment system, clinging or protesting to elicit the response that intermittent reinforcement makes precious and uncertain. Internal working model: I am only safe when proximity is verified; loss is always nearby.
- Avoidant attachment (also called dismissive) develops when the caregiver is consistently unavailable, dismissive of distress, or punishing of dependence. The child learns to deactivate the attachment system, suppressing bids for closeness and developing premature self-sufficiency. Internal working model: Dependence is dangerous; needs must be hidden; I am alone.
- Disorganized attachment develops when the caregiver is both the source of fear and the only available source of safety — typically in contexts of abuse, severe neglect, or unresolved caregiver trauma. The child cannot organize a coherent strategy; approach and avoidance compete in the same moment. Internal working model: Closeness is both desperately needed and actively dangerous.

Hazan and Shaver (1987) extended these patterns to adult romantic relationships. Mikulincer and Shaver's three-decade research program has demonstrated that attachment patterns shape emotion regulation, stress response, caregiving capacity, openness to exploration, and helpseeking across the lifespan. Kirkpatrick (1992, 2005) pioneered the application of attachment theory to religious experience, identifying two pathways by which attachment history shapes the person's image of and relationship with God:

- Correspondence: secure childhood attachment tends to produce a secure God-image (loving, accessible, responsive); insecure childhood attachment tends to produce a corresponding insecure God-image (capricious, distant, threatening).
- Compensation: when human caregivers have been unreliable, some people find in God the secure base that human relationships failed to provide, and develop a particularly intimate, dependent relationship with God as a partial healing of the human attachment wound.

Crucially, attachment patterns are tendencies, not destinies. They are shaped by experience and can be revised by experience. The attachment-theory term for the corrective shift is earned security — the durable change from an insecure pattern to a secure one through repeated experience of reliable, attuned, boundaried relationship with someone who can be the secure base the original caregivers were not. Granqvist's research demonstrates that earned security through religious experience is empirically real: people whose childhood attachment was insecure can develop secure attachment to God through community, healing prayer, sustained Christian relationships, and disciplined formation practice.

These patterns are descriptive, not prescriptive. They explain some variance in religious experience; they do not exhaust the human person. Temperament, culture, sin, spiritual warfare, providence, and the Spirit's sovereign work all shape behavior. Attachment theory is one true lens among several. ATB receives it as common-grace insight without overreading what it can deliver.

3. The Biblical Triad: Faith, Love, Hope

Three theological virtues are explicitly grouped throughout the New Testament: faith (πίστις, *pistis*), love (ἀγάπη, *agapē*), and hope (ἐλπίς, *elpis*). They are listed together in 1 Cor 13:13, 1 Thess 1:3, Col 1:4–5, and Gal 5:5–6. They are not interchangeable; each names a distinct grace and a distinct posture toward God and neighbor. But they are mutually constitutive: faith works through love (Gal 5:6); faith and love arise from hope (Col 1:4–5); hope does not disappoint because the love of God has been poured into our hearts by the Holy Spirit (Rom 5:5).

Faith (covenantal trust). Biblical faith is reliance on the character and promises of God as fulfilled in Jesus Christ. It rests not on human temperament but on God's faithfulness and Christ's finished work (Rom 5:1–5; Eph 1–2). It draws near because the Son has opened the way and the Spirit assures adoption — "Abba, Father" (Heb 4:14–16; Rom 8:15–17). In Reformed terms, faith is God's gift (Eph 2:8–9; Calvin, *Institutes*), the instrument by which we receive Christ. It has content (what God has promised), direction (Godward reliance), and practice (obedience, prayer, sacraments, fellowship). Faith is also embodied in the IJH framework as the central operating variable of the Vol 1 Sowing-and-Reaping law, the Drawing Near Reciprocity law (V1 FL-VII), and the Affective Taxonomy's developmental arc.

Love (covenantal fidelity in action). Biblical love (Hebrew *hesed*; Greek *agapē*) is grounded in God's own self-giving in Christ (1 Jn 4:7–10) and poured into believers' hearts by the Holy Spirit (Rom 5:5). It is patient, kind, truthful, and enduring (1 Cor 13:4–7). It is the *telos* of the triad: "the greatest of these is love" (1 Cor 13:13). In the IJH framework, love is the content of the great commandments (Matt 22:37–39), the fruit of the Spirit (Gal 5:22), and the operating substance of the Drawing Near Reciprocity, Reciprocal Forgiveness (V1 FL-V), and Generosity-Provision (V1 FL-IX) laws.

Hope (forward-leaning expectancy). Biblical hope is confident expectation grounded in God's promises — resurrection, new creation, the Spirit's down payment of the inheritance (1 Pet 1:3; Rom 8:18–25; Eph 1:13–14). It is realistic about suffering and anchored in God's oath (Heb 6:17–20). It is not optimism; it is theologically moored and Spirit-sustained: "May the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace as you trust in him, so that you may overflow with hope by the power of the Holy Spirit" (Rom 15:13). In the IJH framework, hope is the load-bearing virtue of the Endurance-Hope law (V1 FL-XXII), Brueggemann's disorientation-to-new-orientation movement engaged across Vols 1–3, and the eschatological horizon that gives the formation work its weight.

Scripture orders the triad's interplay in concrete sequences. Romans 5:1–5 supplies the canonical one: justified by faith → standing in grace → rejoicing in hope of glory → suffering produces perseverance → perseverance produces character → character produces hope → "and hope does not disappoint, because the love of God has been poured out in our hearts through the Holy Spirit who has been given to us." Faith grants access, God's love is experienced, hope is confirmed — each reinforcing the others.

4. Trust (Faith) and Attachment

Attachment theory's foundational metaphors — safe haven (the place we return to when distressed) and secure base (the foundation from which we explore) — map directly onto biblical images of God. Psalm 23: "The Lord is my shepherd; I shall not want." Psalm 18:2: "The Lord is my rock, my fortress, and my deliverer." Matthew 11:28: "Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest." Hebrews 4:14–16: "Let us then approach God's throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need." The Father in Christ is both safe haven and secure base; the Holy Spirit's witness of adoption (Rom 8:15–17) addresses the felt dimension of trust.

How attachment style shapes the believer's experience of God:

- Secure believers generally find God's nearness emotionally accessible. They pray with expectancy, submit to communal discernment, receive correction as care, and integrate doctrinal truth with felt experience without friction.

- Anxious believers may experience God as unpredictable and oscillate between fervor and despair. They may overinterpret spiritual dryness as abandonment, seek constant reassurance through religious activity, mistake emotional intensity for the Spirit's confirmation, or compulsively perform to secure divine approval.
- Avoidant believers may relate to God primarily intellectually — preferring doctrinal precision to relational intimacy, emphasizing God's transcendence over His immanence, maintaining theological orthodoxy as a defense against vulnerable engagement, and finding language of affection or felt presence uncomfortable. They may be the most theologically rigorous and the most relationally remote members of a congregation simultaneously.
- Disorganized believers experience closeness as both longing and threat. They may swing between intense spiritual experiences and withdrawal, react strongly to spiritual authority figures (idealization, then collapse), and find the same practice (prayer, worship, communion) regulating one week and dysregulating the next.

The Reformed/evangelical distinction between saving faith and psychological trust capacity matters here. Saving faith is the gracious work of the Spirit through the gospel (Eph 2:8–9; Rom 10:17); it is not the product of secure childhood attachment. A believer with profound attachment wounds is no less saved than a believer with secure history. But sanctification — the progressive renewal of the whole person in conformity to Christ — does include the gradual repatterning of attachment-derived relational habits. The Spirit can renovate nature: scripts of vigilance, withdrawal, or chaos can become patterns of wise openness through Scripture, sacrament, community, prayer, and time.

[Cross-reference to existing IJH chapters: V2.Exp7 Hearing with Understanding (where the Affective Taxonomy is operationalized in the integration-not-replacement key); V1 FL-VII Drawing Near Reciprocity (the structural law that names the reciprocity of God's drawing-near and ours); V1 Exp. 8 Prayer as Resonance (the closest existing IJH chapter to attachment-as-relational-resonance).]

5. Love and Attachment

Biblical love is the telos of the triad — the destination toward which faith and hope move. It is also the operational form that mature faith takes (Gal 5:6) and the relational substance the church is called to embody (Heb 10:24–25; 1 Cor 13). Attachment theory's caregiving system — the parallel motivational system that perceives others' needs and responds — supplies a creaturely description of the substrate on which biblical love is practiced.

Felt security enables outward love. Mikulincer and Shaver's research demonstrates that securely attached adults show more empathic caregiving, more forgiveness, more prosocial behavior, and more sustained altruism than insecurely attached adults. The mechanism is not surprising: the energy and attention required for sensitive responsiveness to others is partly the energy not consumed by managing one's own felt insecurity. A person whose attachment system is in

chronic hyperactivation (anxious) or chronic deactivation (avoidant) has less of the relational bandwidth that love-in-action requires.

This converges with the biblical observation that "we love because he first loved us" (1 Jn 4:19) and "perfect love casts out fear" (1 Jn 4:18). The gospel's announcement of the Father's prior, unconditional, electing love is exactly the secure-base experience the insecure-attachment patterns most need. As that love is encountered repeatedly — preached, sacramentally enacted, experienced in reliable Christian community, made felt by the Spirit's witness — the believer's capacity for outward, costly love grows. Faith works through love; faith is love-in-action made plausible by encountered grace.

How attachment style shapes the believer's practice of love:

- Secure believers can give and receive love without fusion or fear. They are typically the people who can speak the truth in love (Eph 4:15), hold their own boundaries while honoring others', and offer compassion without losing themselves.
- Anxious believers may equate love with constant reassurance, fear abandonment in every conflict, use proximity-seeking that inadvertently pressures others, and over-spiritualize emotional intensity. The gospel re-grounds worth in the Father's unearned love, inviting practices (lament, slow prayer, paced response) that widen the window of tolerance for relational uncertainty.
- Avoidant believers may equate love with self-sufficient service — willing to give, resistant to receive — and treat dependence as a failure. Scripture reframes love as mutual self-giving that receives as well as gives (1 Cor 12:21–26); the formation work involves practices of receiving (intercession, blessing, confession, the Lord's Supper as gift) that disarm the defense of competence.
- Disorganized believers may experience love as both longing and threat, oscillating between closeness and withdrawal within the same relationship. Trauma-informed care, consistent boundaries, predictable pastoral structures, and frequently the partnership of a licensed Christian counselor create the safety that gradually makes love sustainable.

[Cross-reference to existing IJH chapters: V1 FL-V Reciprocal Forgiveness; V1 FL-VII Drawing Near Reciprocity; V1 FL-IX Generosity-Provision; V2.Exp4 Confession and Restoration; V2.Exp8 Container (the therapeutic-container chapter); the FoTH practice tradition.]

6. Hope and Attachment

Biblical hope is the forward-leaning anchor of the triad — the virtue that holds the believer through suffering toward the not-yet of resurrection and new creation. Snyder's hope theory in secular psychology decomposes the construct into two components: pathways (perceived routes from the present to the desired future) and agency (the motivational energy to pursue

those routes). Supportive relationships scaffold both; secure attachment correlates with greater capacity for both.

The Romans 5 sequence (suffering → perseverance → character → hope) requires both.

Pathways: the believer must be able to perceive that there are real routes from the current trial to the eventual good — not in this life necessarily, but in the kingdom God has promised.

Agency: the believer must have the motivational energy to walk those routes — to pray when feeling unheard, to obey when results are not visible, to stay in community when wounded.

Both are easier when the believer has the secure-base experience of God's reliable presence and the secure-base experience of a reliable Christian community.

How attachment style shapes the believer's experience of hope:

- Secure believers can maintain expectancy through setbacks, flex goals without despair, and ask for help wisely.
- Anxious believers tend toward catastrophizing and compulsive reassurance-seeking; they may convert spiritual dryness into apocalyptic threat. Pastoral care emphasizes God's steadfastness and slow practices that widen the window of tolerance.
- Avoidant believers tend toward defensive pessimism and self-reliance; they may spiritualize detachment as "maturity" and downplay petitionary prayer. Pastoral care invites concrete dependence — asking, receiving, and waiting with others.
- Disorganized believers experience hope and threat intermingled; they may oscillate between grand expectations and complete withdrawal. Predictable rhythms, trauma-informed counseling, and gentle leadership create the safety required for sustainable expectancy.

Biblical hope is cruciform — shaped by the cross. It does not promise relief in this life; it promises God's faithfulness through whatever this life contains. Performative-positivity cultures undermine hope by suppressing lament and over-realizing the eschatology of comfort; biblical hope tells the truth in the minor key and trusts God for the final cadence.

[Cross-reference to existing IJH chapters: V1 FL-XXII Endurance-Hope; V1 FL-X Ask-Seek-Knock; the Brueggemann-derived suffering-as-formation engine developed across V2 and V3; the eschatological framing in V1 Opening Miracle Frame.]

7. The Triadic Spiral: How Trust, Love, and Hope Reinforce Each Other Through Attachment Dynamics

The triad operates as a mutually reinforcing cycle — "a triadic spiral, a grace-driven, relationally formed cycle that moves from encounter to enactment." The cycle has four phases:

Phase 1 — Encountered Love produces Growing Trust. God's initiating love, preached and sacramentally enacted and made felt by the Spirit, meets the person where they actually are. In

attachment terms, the Father in Christ becomes the safe haven; the church, when reliable and boundaried, echoes that haven. As the person repeatedly experiences attuned presence — pastoral care, small-group reliability, healing prayer practiced humbly (Jas 5:13–16) — felt security rises, and trust in God's promises becomes more emotionally accessible. Faith is still God's gift, but the Spirit ordinarily works through real relationships.

Phase 2 — Stabilized Trust frees Love-in-Action. Faith works through love (Gal 5:6). Confidence in God's character and future grace releases the person from self-protection and turns them toward costly service. In attachment terms, secure-base conditions free the believer to explore outward in mission and to activate the caregiving system with sensitivity and endurance. Doctrinal assurance and congregational reliability make love plausible and sustainable.

Phase 3 — Enacted Love confirms Hope. As love is practiced amid suffering, the Romans 5 sequence unfolds: suffering produces perseverance, perseverance produces character, and character produces hope that does not disappoint because the love of God has been experienced. Concrete testimonies, answered prayers, reconciled relationships, and the steady solace of the Lord's Supper function — psychologically — as agency and pathway cues for hope, and — biblically — as foretastes of the coming kingdom.

Phase 4 — Strengthened Hope generates Fresh Trust and Deeper Love. Eschatological hope — "the hope laid up for you in heaven" (Col 1:4–5) — enlarges the heart's capacity to risk loving again, and faith leans forward more boldly. The spiral tightens: experienced love → enacted faith → confirmed hope → enlarged love → and so on.

Where each attachment pattern enters and resists the spiral:

- Anxious attachment typically enters the spiral at Phase 1 (encountered love) and resists at Phase 2 — the experience of love is intense but the trust does not stabilize, because the working model expects the next experience to be different. The formation work is patience and repetition: many cycles of encountered love before the working model updates.
- Avoidant attachment typically resists at Phase 1 — the encountered love is interpreted as pressure or as something not really happening — and the formation work is embodied rather than primarily verbal: the Lord's Supper, structured small-group vulnerability, practices of receiving (blessing, intercession), which gradually disarm the deactivating defense.
- Disorganized attachment may engage Phases 1 and 3 vividly (intense felt encounters, dramatic hope) but skip Phase 2 (stable trust never lasts); the formation work is consistent boundaries, predictable structures, trauma-informed care, and almost always collaboration with a competent Christian counselor.

The spiral does not depend on any one phase succeeding all at once. Grace is patient with the substrate, and the Spirit's ordinary mode is incremental.

8. The IJH-Specific Contribution: The Sower Soils as Attachment Profiles

The Heart Soil diagnostic in V2.Exp1 already maps the four Sower soils to the five Affective Taxonomy stages: hard path → pre-Level 1; rocky soil → Level 1; thorny soil → Level 2/3; good soil → Levels 3, 4, 5 (30-, 60-, 100-fold). The mapping is internally consistent and explanatorily powerful.

ATB proposes a parallel mapping — not a replacement, an enrichment — between the Sower soils and the four standard attachment patterns:

Sower soil	Affective-Taxonomy mapping (V2.Exp1)	Proposed attachment-style mapping
Hard path (word stolen before it takes root)	Pre-Level 1 — not yet attending	Avoidant dominant — the relational system is deactivated before the Word can land; the defense is "I don't need this."
Rocky soil (initial joy, no root, falls in tribulation)	Level 1 — Responding extrinsically	Anxious dominant — initial enthusiasm is hyperactivated proximity-seeking; tribulation breaks the connection because the working model could not sustain it without external reinforcement.
Thorny soil (growth choked by competing energetic loads)	Level 2 — competing values not yet resolved	Disorganized patterns most often appear here — the approach-avoid conflict generates exactly the "thorns" (oscillating cares, deceitfulness of competing securities, desires for substitutes) that consume the energy required for fruit.
Good soil (30, 60, 100-fold)	Levels 3, 4, 5 — Valuing, Organization, Characterization	Secure pattern (whether by original development or by earned security) — the relational substrate supports increasing depth of integration.

The claim is not that these mappings are one-to-one or causal. It is that the soil condition in a region of a person's heart correlates with the attachment pattern that operates in that same region, and that the formation work of clearing the soil includes the relational work of addressing the substrate.

Three operational implications follow:

4. The "thorny" Level-2-to-Level-3 transition — already identified in V2.Exp1 as the most critical and challenging threshold in the entire Affective Taxonomy — is where attachment-pattern work often becomes critical. Anxious patterns can sustain Level-1 Responding indefinitely without crossing to Level-3 Valuing because intrinsic motivation requires the felt security that anxious patterns cannot supply. Avoidant patterns can sustain Level-2 cognitive engagement indefinitely without crossing to Level-3 Valuing because vulnerable internalization requires the relational openness that avoidant patterns suppress. The formation work that addresses these transitions, accordingly, must address the attachment substrate as well as the cognitive and behavioral surface.
5. The same heart contains multiple soil conditions in different regions (V2.Exp1's Proposed Diagnostic Law). The same heart may also operate from different attachment patterns in different regions: secure with one set of people or topics, anxious with another, avoidant with a third. This is consistent with the contemporary attachment-research finding that adult attachment is more domain-specific than was first appreciated. The formation diagnostic includes asking where a person is operating from which pattern in which region of life.
6. The Foundational Laws operate differently in different attachment substrates. Drawing-Near Reciprocity (V1 FL-VII) means something different to an anxious heart (whose drawing near is hyperactivated and easily mistaken for the law in operation) than to an avoidant heart (whose drawing near is suppressed and whose theological precision can substitute for relational engagement). Confession and Restoration (V1 FL-II) means something different to a disorganized heart (whose vulnerability to ruptured trust is high) than to a secure heart. The laws are universal; the relational pathway by which a particular heart engages them varies.

Open empirical question: does the parallel mapping hold in the FotH practice data? This is exactly the question the FotH attachment-style trackers in the Warrior Monk × TPM packet can begin to answer. The 8-week trackers for anxious / avoidant / disorganized cohorts, if correlated to Sower-diagnostic outcomes from V2.Exp1's diagnostic work, would be the first empirical test of the mapping.

9. Connections to the IJH Framework

ATB's claims connect to existing IJH chapters at the following specific sites:

Vol 1 — Laws of the Spirit

- Exp. 2 — Spirit / Heart / Soul / Mind / Body. Attachment patterns are stored primarily in the Heart layer of the anthropology and expressed through Soul and Body; the formation work crosses all three layers.

- Exp. 7 — Spiritual Authority. Disorganized attachment is especially triggered by spiritual-authority figures; the chapter's discussion of authority-as-stewardship applies directly to the trauma-informed exercise of pastoral and companion roles.
- Exp. 8 — Prayer as Resonance. The phenomenon of prayer as energetic resonance between hearts in the Spirit is mechanically analogous to attachment's affect-co-regulation; ATB strengthens the V1.Exp8 case by supplying a creaturely substrate for the resonance claim.
- FL-II Confession and Restoration; FL-V Reciprocal Forgiveness; FL-VII Drawing Near Reciprocity; FL-X Ask-Seek-Knock; FL-XXII Endurance-Hope. Each of these laws operates through relational substrates that attachment patterns shape. ATB does not replace the laws; it names the substrate on which they operate.

Vol 2 — Knowing to Doing

- Exp. 1 — Heart Soil. The canonical site for the Sower-soils diagnostic; ATB's Section 8 proposes the attachment-style parallel mapping as an enrichment of the existing Affective-Taxonomy mapping.
- Exp. 2 — Emotional Knots. The "knots" the chapter names are partially attachment-derived; ATB supplies the developmental account of how the knots formed and the formation account of how they can untie.
- Exp. 2B — The Adversary's Role. The enemy's exploitation of attachment wounds (especially in early childhood) is a recurring pastoral observation in the FotH tradition; ATB names the mechanism with attachment-theory precision.
- Exp. 4 — Confession and Restoration. The chapter's practice is attachment-formative when done in a reliable, boundaried, attuned context.
- Exp. 6 — Tool Map; Exp. 7 — Hearing with Understanding. The Affective Taxonomy's integration-not-replacement reading applies to attachment patterns as well as to stages: a "secure" believer who has no anxious sensitivity to the loss of relational closeness or avoidant discernment about premature intimacy is not mature — they are closed.
- Exp. 8 — Container. The therapeutic-container chapter is operationally the attachment-formative site of the FotH practice.
- Exp. 10 — Training Plan. The Daily / Weekly / Mission rhythms named in the Training Plan are exactly the consistency-and-presence conditions under which earned security develops.

Vol 3 — Quantitative Framework

- Exp. 4 — Spiritual Distance. ATB strengthens the case that the Affective Taxonomy level is one valid measurement of Truth-axis spiritual distance, and adds that the integration check (V4 §2) properly includes the attachment-substrate check.
- Exp. 5 — Spiritual Force, Energy and Power. The energetic dynamics of community resonance discussed here include the attachment-derived energetic dynamics of safe-haven and secure-base function.
- Open Trails. ATB proposes attachment-style measurement as an addition to the future-research program developed in this chapter (see Recommended Placement below).

Vol 4 — Testing Framework

- §2 — Integration-not-replacement reading. The framing applies to attachment patterns: maturity is the held integration of secure baseline with the wisdom of having been anxious (relational sensitivity to loss), avoidant (discernment about premature intimacy), and disorganized (capacity to hold contradictions in the same moment). A "secure" person who has lost the sensitivities of the other patterns is not mature — they are insulated.
- §3 — Individual Testing Protocol. The SIP-Individual instrument can be extended with attachment-style dimensions; ATB proposes specific items in Future Work below.
- §4 — Small-Group Testing Protocol. The Group SIP can incorporate attachment-pattern observation as part of the facilitator's diagnostic work.

Vol 5 — References

- Existing Formation Documents. ATB is positioned as the eighth Formation Document, complementing TA (anthropology), HFT (affective taxonomy), SST (soul/spirit taxonomies), MSFIG (integration model), MSF (measurement at scale), FC (formation companion role), and 4Cs (four connection points). ATB sits closest to FC in that both name how the formation work happens; ATB adds the attachment substrate on which FC's relational competencies operate.
- Part I bibliography. Bowlby, Ainsworth, Hazan & Shaver, Mikulincer & Shaver, Kirkpatrick, Granqvist, and Snyder would each gain entries upon publication of ATB.

10. Operational Practices: The FotH Whole-Person Integration

ATB's operational core is the work that the Fellowship of the Heart community have developed over many years, expressed most recently in the Warrior Monk × Attachment-Informed Christian / TPM packet. Four operational components map directly onto the theological claims of Sections 4–7:

Component 1 — TPM (Transformation Prayer Ministry) as attachment-aware mind renewal. TPM's MAP — EMOTION → MEMORY → BELIEF → TRUTH → TRANSFORMATION, with Helper Boxes for SOLUTION (resistance) and ANGER — is operationally a Spirit-led practice for surfacing the belief layer of attachment-derived working models and presenting it to the Lord for re-patterning. The Solution Box, in particular, is operationally a diagnostic for the protective defenses of all three insecure attachment patterns (anxious hyperactivating solutions; avoidant deactivating solutions; disorganized oscillating solutions). TPM done well is attachment work done in the Spirit's presence.

Component 2 — Attachment-style practice cards. The packet supplies three short, repeatable practices targeted to each insecure pattern:

- Reassurance Cooldown (Anxious) — notice the urge to seek reassurance; rate distress (SUDS 0–10); wait ten minutes using breath and grounding; journal the fear; ask once clearly; receive the answer without re-asking; thank the person; re-ground for one minute. Scripture anchor: Ps 56:3.
- Receiving Drill (Avoidant) — choose a safe person; ask them to pray for you for 60–90 seconds; your only words are "Yes" and "Amen"; notice sensations and breathe; afterward say "Thank you" without immediate reciprocation. Scripture anchor: Matt 7:7.
- Exit/Return Plan (Disorganized) — signal to step out when overwhelmed; exit to a pre-agreed spot; use grounding for 2–5 minutes; return when SUDS ≤ 5; tell leader "Ready to return." Scripture anchor: Heb 4:16.

These are small, repeatable, embodied, scripturally anchored. They train the substrate one micro-moment at a time. They are also empirically tractable: the 8-week trackers in the packet are exactly the data the eventual empirical research on the Sower-and-attachment mapping (Section 8 above) would draw from.

Component 3 — Whole-Person Integration matrix. The packet's Heart–Spirit–Soul–Mind–Body integration is grounded in Willard's anthropology (and through Willard in TA, the IJH Theological Anthropology Formation Document). The matrix supplies a diagnostic for where in the person a particular attachment-derived pattern is manifesting and which formation practice (lament, intention prayer, rule-of-life check, PROAPT scripture engagement, embodied grounding) addresses it. ATB's contribution to the matrix is the explicit attachment-substrate dimension: the same Whole-Person practice does different work in different attachment substrates.

Component 4 — Group covenant, safety practices, and trauma-informed structure. The packet's group-covenant requirements (confidentiality within legal limits, consent for touch/prayer/questions, presence and time limits, prompt rupture repair, no unsolicited advice, cultural humility) and the SUDS scale + grounding menu + safety plan together constitute the reliable, boundaried, attuned community that attachment-theory research identifies as the necessary condition for earned security. The packet's care to position itself as complementary to (not a replacement for) licensed mental-health care reflects the wise pastor/counselor collaboration the GPT-5 paper recommends.

11. Reading Attachment Styles as Integration, Not Replacement

The Affective Taxonomy is read across the IJH project as integration-not-replacement (canonical surfaces: V2.Exp7 pastoral; Vol 4 §2 construct-level). The same framing applies to attachment styles:

Mature attachment is not "always secure." It is the held capacity for all four sensitivities, with secure as the regulating baseline.

- The mature believer retains anxious sensitivity — alertness to the loss of relational closeness, capacity to feel the cost of separation, the proper grief of distance from God. Without it, the heart hardens to the loss of those it should love.
- The mature believer retains avoidant discernment — the capacity to recognize when intimacy is being pressed before trust has been established, when boundary-maintenance is wisdom rather than defense. Without it, the heart fuses with what should be held at appropriate distance.
- The mature believer retains disorganized awareness — the capacity to hold contradictions in the same moment, to live with longing-and-fear when the situation contains both, to sit with paradox rather than resolving it prematurely. Without it, the heart flattens what should be held in tension.
- The mature believer's secure baseline is the regulating ground from which the other three sensitivities operate without overwhelming the whole. Secure-as-baseline is what makes the other sensitivities load-bearing rather than disabling.

A believer whose secure baseline has eclipsed all three sensitivities is not mature — they are insulated. They are the relational analog of the Stage-5 Pharisee diagnosed in V2.Exp7: formally well-formed, operationally closed. The pastoral and diagnostic work of ATB therefore includes the integration check — is the believer's secure baseline holding the other three sensitivities open, or has it replaced them?

This is the same structural move the Cameron-and-Quinn-derived held-tensions reading makes for the Foundational Laws (V1 Supplemental on Held Tensions and Shadow Pairs) and the integration-not-replacement reading makes for the Affective Taxonomy. ATB extends the discipline to the attachment dimension: health is the held capacity for all four; pathology is the collapse to one, including the apparently-good collapse to "always secure."

12. Pastoral / Companion Implications

Trauma-informed shepherding. Assume a non-trivial portion of any congregation or small group carries histories of attachment-relevant relational trauma. Train leaders in basic attachment-aware postures: consistency, attunement, non-defensive listening, clear boundaries, explicit consent, prompt rupture repair, normalized lament. Secure trust grows slowly; the formation work is patient.

Wise referral and collaboration. Pastors and companions are not psychotherapists. Build active collaborative relationships with licensed Christian counselors who understand attachment and trauma. With consent, coordinate care so therapy (emotion regulation, narrative repair, trauma processing) and discipleship (Scripture, prayer, community, sacrament) cohere. Therapy is a creaturely means God often uses; treating it as spiritual failure is itself a pastoral malformation.

Small-group life as the secure-base laboratory. Structure groups with clear covenants (confidentiality, presence, grace-truth balance, repair norms). Train facilitators to name and normalize attachment dynamics non-shamingly ("It makes sense you hesitate to ask for prayer; that's a familiar pattern for many of us"). Encourage steady rhythms (weekly meetings, predictable check-ins, named expectations) that embody God's reliability over time.

Charismatic practice with attachment awareness. Healing prayer, prophecy, and the gifts more broadly can serve as embodied experiences of attuned divine and human presence. They can also retraumatize when done badly — pressuring the anxious to perform, demanding vulnerability from the avoidant, dysregulating the disorganized through unpredictable intensity. The FoTH practice tradition's attention to consent, predictable structure, safety language, and trauma-informed referral is exactly the kind of charismatic accountability ATB's claims require.

Leadership reliability as pastoral love. Keep promises. Communicate early. Repair ruptures publicly when necessary. Personnel reviews and pastoral care plans should include attachment-aware training. The manner of ministry makes the doctrine plausible — or implausible — to attachment-strained members of the congregation.

Preaching adoption. Make the Fatherhood of God and union with Christ recurring themes. Preach perseverance and assurance to anchor anxious souls; preach dependence and prayer to soften avoidant hearts; preach the unchanging character of God to provide the stable reference point disorganized souls need.

13. Cautions and Limits

Scope of attachment theory. Attachment theory illumines significant dimensions of human relating; it does not exhaust the human person. Temperament, culture, sin, demonic oppression, spiritual warfare, and God's mysterious providence all shape behavior. ATB resists reducing every spiritual struggle to attachment dynamics; some struggles are sin requiring repentance, some are warfare requiring resistance, some are providence requiring trust.

The Creator-creature distinction. Attachment theory's metaphors (safe haven, secure base) resonate with biblical images of God; they are not equivalent to the biblical doctrine of God. God is not a bigger parent; He is the covenant Lord revealed in Christ. The attachment metaphors are useful for naming creaturely correlates of biblical truth; they are not the truth itself.

Cultural variability. Attachment-research instruments were developed in particular cultural contexts (largely Western, largely emphasizing individual autonomy and emotional expressiveness). Non-Western cultures often prioritize interdependence and emotional restraint in ways that recalibrate the meaning of "secure" or "avoidant." Application of attachment categories to spiritual formation must respect cultural variability while maintaining biblical authority on what love, faith, and hope finally are.

Saving faith vs. psychological trust capacity. Saving faith is the gracious work of the Spirit through the gospel (Eph 2:8–9); it is not produced by secure attachment, and it is not prevented by insecure attachment. A profoundly insecurely-attached believer is no less saved than a securely-attached one. ATB names attachment as part of the substrate on which sanctification operates, not as part of the ground on which justification rests.

Avoid psychologizing revelation and proof-texting psychology. Do not force one-to-one mappings (e.g., "secure attachment causes strong faith"). Receive empirical insights as common-grace descriptions of creaturely means the Spirit often uses; let special revelation continue to norm doctrine and practice.

Continuationism / cessationism charity. Continuationists should heed cessationist cautions about authority, order, and abuse. Cessationists can affirm the Spirit's ongoing experiential ministry in assurance and love even while differing on the contemporary operation of miraculous gifts. Charity protects the vulnerable.

Resist prosperity and performative healing narratives. Some attachment patterns will not fully heal in this life. Some believers will struggle with attachment wounds while growing in godliness and service for decades. God's power is perfected in weakness (2 Cor 12:9). ATB does not promise complete repatterning; it names the direction of the Spirit's patient work.

14. Conclusion

Attachment theory describes the creaturely substrate through which human persons learn to expect closeness or distance, comfort or threat, presence or abandonment. Scripture reveals the God who is the perfect attachment figure — Father in Christ, indwelt by the Spirit, faithful through all generations, the safe haven and secure base from whom and to whom every right relationship derives. The biblical triad of faith, love, and hope names the graces by which the Spirit progressively repatterns the substrate, drawing the believer through encountered love into growing trust, through stabilized trust into love-in-action, through enacted love into confirmed hope, and through strengthened hope into ever-enlarging love.

The local church, when it is ordered by the Word and enlivened by the Spirit and structured with the consistency, attunement, and reliability that attachment-theory research identifies as necessary for earned security, becomes the relational ecology God ordinarily uses to do this work. The Fellowship of the Heart practice tradition supplies the operational practices — TPM as attachment-aware mind renewal, the attachment-style practice cards, the Whole-Person integration matrix, the safety-conscious small-group structure — through which the gospel meets the substrate where it actually lives. The integration-not-replacement reading applied to attachment styles preserves the wisdom of all four sensitivities while establishing the secure baseline as the regulating ground.

Hope, finally, does not rest on achieved secure attachment. It rests on the God who promises "I will never leave you nor forsake you" (Heb 13:5). That promise transcends the substrate; it transforms the substrate; in the resurrection it will heal the substrate completely. Until then, the Spirit's patient work continues, and the church bears witness — sometimes haltingly, always graciously — to the love that casts out fear.

15. Future Work

The following are the most promising research and development trails opened by ATB:

7. Empirical test of the Sower-and-attachment parallel mapping (Section 8). Use FotH's 8-week attachment-style trackers correlated with V2.Exp1 Sower-diagnostic outcomes to test whether soil condition in a region of life predicts attachment-pattern signature in that same region.
 8. Extension of the SIP-Individual (Vol 4 §3) with attachment-style dimensions. Design and pilot specific items that probe attachment patterns within the same forced-choice 100-point distribution structure adapted from Cameron and Quinn's OCAI. Preserve the integration check.
 9. Extension of the Group SIP (Vol 4 §4) with attachment-pattern facilitator-observation tools. Train facilitators to recognize the four patterns in group dynamics and to record observations in a way that supports both pastoral care and research.
 10. Integration with the Vol 1 Foundational Laws. Specific systematic work on how each insecure attachment pattern characteristically distorts a given Foundational Law's operation, and what targeted formation work re-aligns it. Drawing-Near Reciprocity (V1 FL-VII) is the most natural starting point.
 11. Cross-tradition application. The MSF tradition-plateaus analysis (Reformed at L2, Evangelical at L2-3, Charismatic at L3, Mystical at L3-4) suggests that each tradition may also have characteristic attachment-pattern affinities — tradition-attachment-style affinity is an open research question with practical implications for cross-tradition formation work.
 12. Long-form Formation Document publication. When the empirical work has matured and John's editing has shaped the prose, formal publication of ATB as the eighth Formation Document PDF, with a Vol 5 summary chapter (mirroring the MSF treatment) and cross-references from Vol 1 / Vol 2 / Vol 4 chapters.
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Bibliography

This bibliography draws together the works cited across ATB and the three source papers, organized by topic. Entries are in Turabian author-date short form with a brief annotation describing what each work contributes to ATB. Reformed-evangelical theological works are listed at the end; the empirical attachment-research works and the spiritual-formation works

are listed in their respective sections. IJH's existing Formation Documents and the Cameron-and-Quinn entries already in Vol 5 Part I are cross-referenced rather than re-described here.

Attachment Theory: Foundational Works

Ainsworth, M. D. S., Blehar, M. C., Waters, E., & Wall, S. (1978). *Patterns of attachment: A psychological study of the strange situation*. Lawrence Erlbaum. The empirical foundation of contemporary attachment research — the Baltimore Longitudinal Study and the Strange Situation paradigm that produced the secure / anxious / avoidant infant-classification system later supplemented by the disorganized category. Cited throughout ATB Section 2.

Bowlby, J. (1969/1982). *Attachment and loss, Vol. 1: Attachment* (2nd ed.). Basic Books. The originating theoretical statement: human infants possess an innate behavioral system for maintaining proximity to caregivers under threat, and the quality of that early experience produces durable "internal working models" that shape relational expectation across the lifespan. The substrate concept that runs throughout ATB.

Bowlby, J. (1988). *A secure base: Parent-child attachment and healthy human development*. Basic Books. Bowlby's late summary of the clinical implications of attachment theory, including the "secure base" concept that ATB's biblical-images mapping (Ps 23; Heb 4:14–16) leans on.

Hazan, C., & Shaver, P. R. (1987). Romantic love conceptualized as an attachment process. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 52(3), 511–524. The first extension of attachment theory beyond infant–caregiver dyads into adult romantic relationships — the work that made adult-attachment research possible and that supports ATB's claim that attachment dynamics shape the believer's adult experience of God and Christian community.

Mikulincer, M., & Shaver, P. R. (2016). *Attachment in adulthood: Structure, dynamics, and change* (2nd ed.). Guilford Press. The standard contemporary reference for adult-attachment research, summarizing three decades of work on how attachment patterns shape emotion regulation, caregiving capacity, stress response, helpseeking, and openness to exploration. ATB Sections 4–7 lean on this synthesis throughout.

Mikulincer, M., & Shaver, P. R. (2020). Enhancing the broaden and build cycle of attachment security in adulthood. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*, 17(6), 2054. The mechanism by which felt security widens the believer's capacity for outward love and exploration — the empirical correlate of ATB's Triadic Spiral (Section 7).

Attachment and Religion / Spirituality

Beck, R., & McDonald, A. (2004). Attachment to God: The Attachment to God Inventory, tests of working model correspondence, and an exploration of faith group differences. *Journal of Psychology and Theology*, 32(2), 92–103. The most widely used empirical instrument for measuring attachment to God; supplies the operational tools the future ATB measurement extension (Section 15 future work) would adapt and integrate with the IJH SIP framework.

Bradshaw, M., & Kent, B. V. (2017). Prayer, attachment to God, and changes in psychological well-being in later life. *Journals of Gerontology, Series B*, 73(2), 212–222. Longitudinal evidence that prayer practices shape attachment-to-God over time — empirical support for ATB's claim that the formation work patiently repatterns the substrate.

Davis, E. B., Granqvist, P., & Sharp, C. (2018). Theistic relational spirituality: Development, dynamics, health, and transformation. *Psychology of Religion and Spirituality*, 10(3), 192–204. The leading contemporary synthesis of attachment research applied to Christian spirituality; ATB's theoretical frame is consonant with this synthesis while extending it into the IJH-specific Sower-mapping and FotH-practices applications.

Granqvist, P. (2020). *Attachment in religion and spirituality: A wider view*. Guilford Press. The most comprehensive single-volume treatment of attachment theory's application to religious experience; supplies the documentation that "earned security" through religious community and practice is empirically real (cited in ATB Section 2).

Granqvist, P., Mikulincer, M., & Shaver, P. R. (2010). Religion as attachment: Normative processes and individual differences. *Personality and Social Psychology Review*, 14(1), 49–59. The clearest single statement of the correspondence-vs-compensation pathways by which attachment history shapes God-images, summarized in ATB Section 2.

Kirkpatrick, L. A. (1992). An attachment-theory approach to the psychology of religion. *International Journal for the Psychology of Religion*, 2(1), 3–28. The foundational paper introducing attachment theory as a framework for the psychology of religion; proposes the correspondence/compensation distinction that ATB Section 2 uses.

Kirkpatrick, L. A. (2005). *Attachment, evolution, and the psychology of religion*. Guilford Press. The book-length development of Kirkpatrick's attachment-and-religion program.

Kirkpatrick, L. A., & Shaver, P. R. (1990). Attachment theory and religion: Childhood attachments, religious beliefs, and conversion. *Journal for the Scientific Study of Religion*, 29(3), 315–334. The first empirical study connecting childhood attachment history to adult religious experience.

Pirutinsky, S., Rosmarin, D. H., & Kirkpatrick, L. A. (2019). Is attachment to God a unique predictor of mental health? Test in a Jewish sample. *International Journal for the Psychology of Religion*, 29(3), 167–179. Cross-tradition evidence that attachment to God independently predicts mental health beyond human-attachment effects — supports ATB's theological claim that the believer's relationship with God is itself attachment-formative.

Zahl, B. P., & Gibson, N. J. S. (2012). God representations, attachment to God, and satisfaction with life: A comparison of doctrinal and experiential representations of God in Christian young adults. *Journal of Psychology and Theology*, 40(2), 113–124. Empirical demonstration that

experienced God-images, more than *doctrinal* God-images, correlate with attachment-to-God measures — supports ATB's distinction between cognitive belief and felt trust.

Hope Theory

Snyder, C. R. (2002). Hope theory: Rainbows in the mind. *Psychological Inquiry*, 13(4), 249–275. The pathways/agency decomposition of hope that ATB Section 6 uses to bridge psychological and biblical hope. Snyder's research-grade definition is creaturely; ATB's biblical-hope framing locates the agency and pathways under grace.

Religion / Spirituality and Coping

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Pargament, K. I. (2002). The bitter and the sweet: An evaluation of the costs and benefits of religiousness. *Psychological Inquiry*, 13(3), 168–181. The classic statement that religiousness has measurable costs as well as benefits — supports ATB's cautions (Section 13) against over-spiritualizing or under-naming the real wounds attachment work addresses.

Pargament, K. I., Feuille, M., & Burdzy, D. (2011). The Brief RCOPE: Current psychometric status of a short measure of religious coping. *Religions*, 2(1), 51–76. The standard short-form religious-coping instrument; potentially relevant for the ATB future-work measurement extension.

Spiritual Formation

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Krathwohl, D. R., Bloom, B. S., & Masia, B. B. (1964). *Taxonomy of educational objectives: Handbook II: Affective domain*. David McKay. The source taxonomy from which HFT and the IJH integration-not-replacement reading derive. ATB extends the same integration discipline to attachment styles (Section 11).

Smith, J. K. A. (2009). *Desiring the kingdom: Worship, worldview, and cultural formation*. Baker Academic.

Smith, J. K. A. (2013). *Imagining the kingdom: How worship works*. Baker Academic. Smith's two books together argue that humans are formed primarily by liturgical practices that shape *desire* (the affective domain) prior to cognition. Convergent with ATB's claim that the formation work meets the substrate where it actually lives — in embodied practice, not primarily in cognition.

Wilhoit, J. (2022). *Spiritual formation as if the church mattered* (2nd ed.). Baker Academic. The leading evangelical text on church-based spiritual formation; consonant with ATB's emphasis on the local church as the ecology of earned security.

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Willard, D. (1998). Spiritual disciplines, spiritual formation, and the restoration of the soul. *Journal of Psychology and Theology*, 26(1), 101–109. Willard's clearest statement of how the spiritual disciplines repattern the soul over time — the discipline-side complement to ATB's relational-formation account.

Reformed / Evangelical / Charismatic Theology

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- **SST — Soul and Spirit Taxonomies** (Formation Document, IJH Vol 5 source-pdfs).
- **MSFIG — A Model of Spiritual Formation for Individuals and Small Groups** (Formation Document, IJH Vol 5 source-pdfs).
- **MSF — Measuring Spiritual Formation at Scale** (Formation Document, IJH Vol 5 source-pdfs; summary chapter at docs/volume-5-references/measuring-spiritual-formation-at-scale.md).
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- **Rifkin, Stan** entry in IJH Vol 5 Part I. The mentor formation upstream of the consulting practice that shaped the held-tensions reading.

Source Papers (the three inputs to this synthesis)

13. Warrior Monk × Attachment-Informed Christian / TPM Packet (John Tittle, FotH 2025). Operational participant packet integrating TPM with attachment-informed practices and whole-person integration. ATB Section 10 condenses this packet.
14. "Trust and Attachment: An Integrative Perspective from Reformed, Evangelical, and Charismatic Biblical Faith" (AnswerThis.io research assistant, 2025). A faithful Reformed/evangelical/charismatic synthesis on the trust-attachment connection. ATB Sections 4, 11, 12 draw from this paper.
15. "Attachment Theory with Faith (Trust), Hope, and Love, and the Integration of These Four" (John Tittle with GPT-5 assistance, v6, 2025). The most comprehensive of the three; supplies

the structural backbone for ATB Sections 4–7 and the cautions in Section 13. John's own framing of the Sower question opens ATB Preface.
